

TAT: Tapas Acupressure Technique¹

Begin by identifying the ring finger and thumb of one of your hands. With these two fingers, gently grasp the bridge of your nose, between your eyes. *(Pause)* When you are comfortable with that position, adjust your arm and wrist so that you can place the middle finger of the same hand on your lower middle forehead, about half an inch higher than the area between your eyebrows. *(Pause)* You now have fingers on three facial points. This is called the *pose*. Hold that pose during each of the **T-A-T** steps. While you hold the pose, breathe deeply and follow the instructions. Remember to breathe deeply.

Take this gently. During the pause, use as much time as you need for jotting down some notes about your experience.

1. Choose an issue or problem. *(Pause) (Repeat the instruction)*

You might want to choose one of your hotspots as your problem. Observe yourself enduring the experience of that hotspot. What are you thinking and feeling? Are you feeling hurt, defensive, enraged, or scared? If you can, experience the sensations in your body when you access those feelings. What stories or judgments are in your mind? *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Hold the pose and breathe for thirty seconds. *(Pause for 30 seconds)* In this first step, people sometimes try to talk themselves out of the problem or the feelings with positive affirmations. They are trying to save their lives. Try to stay in the problem for another thirty seconds while continuing to hold the pose. Breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Now pause. Take as long as you wish to jot down a few words that will help you remember what you thought and felt about the problem. On a scale of one to ten, with ten being the most intense, rate the intensity of your discomfort about the problem or the amount of resistance that you feel while exploring this issue. Make a note of that.

Take the pose again, and breathe.

2. Imagine how you would think and feel, and what your life would be like, if you did not have this problem. *(Pause for 1 minute) (Repeat the instruction) (Pause for 1 minute)*

Pause and take as long as you need to jot down a few descriptive words.

Now take the pose again, and breathe.

3. Listen to the clearing statement: “God, thank You for healing the origins of this problem.” *(Repeat) (Pause for 1 minute) “The origins of this problem are healing now.” (Pause for 1 minute)*

Pause. Take a few notes. How are you feeling?

Take the pose again, and keep breathing.

4. Listen to the clearing statement: ***“God, thank You for healing all the areas of my life, mind, and body that are misoriented by this problem.” (Pause for 1 minute) “All the areas of my life, mind, and body that are misoriented by this problem are healing now.” (Pause for 1 minute)***

Pause. If you have any thoughts about that, write them down now.

Take the pose, and breathe.

5. Listen to the clearing statement: ***“God, thank You for healing all the places in me that get something out of holding on to this problem.” (Pause for 1 minute) “All the places in me that get something out of holding on to this problem are healing now.” (Pause for 1 minute)***

Pause. If you have any thoughts, jot a few of them down.

Take the pose, and breathe.

6. Listen to the clearing statement: ***“I forgive everyone and everything that I have blamed for this problem, including God and myself.” Breathe, and on the exhale, let go. (Pause for 1 minute) “I forgive everyone and everything that I have held responsible for this problem, including God and myself.” Breathe, and on the exhale, let go. (Pause for 1 minute)***

Pause. Jot down any thoughts that you might have.

Take the pose, and breathe deeply one last time.

7. Listen to the clearing statement: ***“I ask forgiveness from everyone and everything that I have harmed by holding on to this problem, including God’s purposes and my True Self.” Breathe. (Pause for 1 minute) “I ask forgiveness from everyone and everything that I have harmed by holding on to this problem, including God’s purposes and my True Self.” Breathe. (Pause for 1 minute)***

Pause. Make a note of any thoughts you might have.

Write down how you now feel about the problem. On a scale of one to ten, how would you rate the intensity of your discomfort or resistance when you think about the problem? Compare this number with your assessment in step 1.

¹ en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tapas_Acupressure_Technique. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.